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Task 6

Social Engineering Awareness

Social Engineering Awareness Guide

1. What is Social Engineering?

Social engineering is a cybersecurity technique where attackers manipulate people into revealing sensitive information or performing unsafe actions.

Example: An attacker pretends to be a bank employee and asks for an OTP or password.

2. Common Social Engineering Techniques

Phishing

Attackers send fake emails or messages containing malicious links to steal information.

Example: “Your bank account will be blocked. Click here to verify.”

Impersonation

The attacker pretends to be a trusted person such as a manager, bank employee, or IT staff.

Example: A fake IT employee asks for your login password.

Pretexting

The attacker creates a fake story or situation to obtain confidential information.

Example: Someone pretends to be a bank employee and asks for personal details for “verification.”

Baiting

The attacker uses something attractive to make the victim perform an unsafe action.

Example: An unknown USB labelled “Important Files” is left in an office.

Quid Pro Quo

The attacker offers something in return for information or access.

Example: A fake technician offers to fix a computer in exchange for the user's password.

Tailgating

An unauthorized person follows an authorized person into a restricted area.

Example: Someone follows an employee through a secure office door.

3. Warning Signs

Be careful when you see:

- Urgent or threatening messages
- Requests for passwords or OTPs

- Unknown links or attachments
 - Someone pretending to be an authority
 - Suspicious payment requests
 - Unexpected prizes or offers
 - Requests to bypass security procedures
 - Unusual requests from known people
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4. How to Stay Safe

- Never share your password or OTP.
 - Verify the sender before responding.
 - Do not click suspicious links.
 - Do not open unexpected attachments.
 - Use strong and unique passwords.
 - Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).
 - Do not connect unknown USB devices.
 - Verify urgent requests through another trusted method.
 - Report suspicious activity to the appropriate security/IT team.
 - Think before clicking, sharing, or responding.
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5. Quick Safety Checklist

Before responding to a suspicious request, ask:

STOP → THINK → VERIFY → RESPOND

- Who is contacting me?
- Why do they need this information?
- Is the request urgent?
- Is the link or attachment genuine?
- Can I verify the request through an official channel?

6. Conclusion

Social engineering attacks exploit human trust, fear, curiosity, and urgency. Being aware of warning signs and verifying suspicious requests can help prevent these attacks.

Remember: Think before you trust, click, share, or respond.

Interview Questions

1. What is social engineering?

Social engineering is a technique in which attackers manipulate people into revealing sensitive information or performing unsafe actions.

2. What is pretexting?

Pretexting is a social engineering technique in which an attacker creates a fake situation or identity to obtain information from a victim.

3. How can employees prevent social engineering?

Employees can prevent social engineering by verifying requests, avoiding suspicious links, protecting passwords and OTPs, using MFA, and reporting suspicious activities.